THE MASTERMIND COACHING CLASSES

CBSE / RBSE • NURSERY – CLASS XII • JAIPUR

Road No. 5, VKIA, Jaipur — 9887258679

ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 1

Chapter 25: **The Trees (First Flight Poem)** | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(b)** extended personification	Trees as agents.
2	**(c)** leaves the poet's own fate unresolved	Ambiguity.
3	**(d)** a relative clause	Defining.
4	**(c)** A Tiger in the Zoo	Captive longing.
5	**(b)** an unresolved tension between involvement and distance	Ambivalence.
6	**(a)** nature absorbs and transforms light	Image.
7	**(d)** about to happen	Soon.
8	**(b)** women seeking release from domestic confinement	Interpretation.
9	**(b)** uses nature as a symbol of human longing	Symbolic.
10	**(a)** reverent	Respect.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	It describes a real scene of trees in a room (1) while the same scene stands for freedom and confinement (1).	1+1
12	It fractures the moon's reflection (1) suggesting disrupted perception and change (1).	1+1
13	Forests are empty without trees (1) and the trees' return suggests restoration (1).	1+1
14	Open symbols invite many readings (1) and allow the reader to participate in making meaning (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	Trees are given will (1). It makes their longing human (1). But it may make them symbols, not real trees (1).	1+1+1
16	It treats trees as beings (1). It values their habitat (1). It calls for respect (1).	1+1+1
17	She said, 'The trees are leaving.' (1). Quotation marks (1). Tense changes to present (1).	1+1+1
	OR: She watches but does not act (1). She feels kinship (1). She remains indoors, suggesting divided feelings (1).	1+1+1
18	Night frames the scene (1). Moon light is fractured (1). Light hints at possibility (1).	1+1+1
	OR: While the poet wrote, the trees moved (1). Although they were rooted, they strained free (1). They moved so that the forest might live again (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Trees as rebels (1). Quiet voice (1). Images of struggle (1). Poet's role (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Setting (1). Characters (1). Plan (1). Escape (1). Ending (1).	2+2+1
20	Symbol (1). Image (1). Structure (1). Tone (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1
	OR: No resolution (1). Reader participation (1). Multiple readings (1). Mood (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1

Mistakes to avoid:

- Saying the trees are outside the house moving in; the poem says the trees are **moving out** from the room toward the forest.
- Missing the personification: the trees **try to leave**, a symbol of freedom.
- Treating the poem as only about nature; it also suggests **freedom from confinement**, even women's longing for release.
- Mixing the poet: **Adrienne Rich**, who writes in free verse about nature and human liberty.
- Ignoring the images, such as the cold night and the moon 'broken like a mast'; write one image with its meaning.
- Spelling slips: *glass, forest, personification, free verse, inching*.

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 2

Chapter 25: **The Trees (First Flight Poem)** | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(b)** the forest's emptiness and need for restoration	Interpretation.
2	**(d)** immediacy	Immediate.
3	**(d)** restraint on living beings is temporary	Lesson.
4	**(d)** disrupted reflection and bad omen or change	Ambiguous.
5	**(a)** The poem questions limits imposed on beings	Valid.
6	**(d)** explained the symbols in prose	Over-explaining.
7	**(a)** decide whether the trees (and poet) succeed	Open.
8	**(c)** kinship tinged with separation	Kinship.
9	**(c)** it names the subject without revealing the meaning	Title.
10	**(a)** free verse	Form.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	Potted trees are domesticated (1) but their urge to leave shows nature cannot be fully tamed (1).	1+1
12	We do not see the escape completed (1) nor the poet's decision (1).	1+1
13	It creates immediacy (1) as if the escape is happening now (1).	1+1
14	Roots tear (1) so liberation is painful (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	Opening image (1). Rising tension (1). Open conclusion (1).	1+1+1
16	Hope: trees do move (1). Despair: poet remains behind (1). Overall, tentative hope (1).	1+1+1
17	shift, stream, migrate (1). The trees seemed to migrate (1). Each shows a shade of movement (1).	1+1+1
	OR: It uses domestic setting (1). It voices a desire for liberation (1). It leaves the outcome open (1).	1+1+1
18	Ask who the trees represent (1). Discuss limits on freedom (1). Link to students' lives (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Alliteration (1). Assonance (1). They create music (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Captives (1). Tiger: anger (1). Trees: movement (1). Tone and form (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Greeting (1). Poem (1). Roots (1). Wings (1). Closing (1).	2+2+1
20	Intro (1). Feminist reading (1). Ecological reading (1). Overlap (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Personification (1). Poet's presence (1). Social reading (1). Ecological reading (1). Judgement (1).	2+2+1

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ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 3

Chapter 25: **The Trees (First Flight Poem)** | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(a)** a still image with slow motion	Stillness.
2	**(d)** intensifying the central image	Compression.
3	**(d)** pregnant with possibility	Anticipation.
4	**(d)** visual and kinetic	Seen and moving.
5	**(c)** the poem is only about plants	Literal reading.
6	**(d)** constraint and freedom	Binary.
7	**(d)** Never before had the trees looked so alive.	Inversion after 'never before'.
8	**(a)** the seated poet and moving trees	Contrast.
9	**(d)** painful severance from restrictive ties	Painful freedom.
10	**(d)** were	Second conditional.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	Its lack of fixed pattern mirrors the trees' unbinding (1) and creates a fluid rhythm (1).	1+1
12	Writing is a form of freedom (1) yet she stays in the room, showing tension (1).	1+1
13	Movement is silent and slow (1) which makes the change eerie and powerful (1).	1+1
14	It resonates with issues of environment and personal freedom (1) which remain relevant (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	Flowing lines (1). Soft consonants (1). Enjambment imitating motion (1).	1+1+1
16	Straining at their roots, the trees move out of the room toward the empty forest (1). Participial phrase (1). Clear subject (1).	1+1+1
17	Room with window (1). Trees pressing out (1). Moon over the oak (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Room: limits, human order (1). Forest: freedom, nature (1). Their opposition drives the poem (1).	1+1+1
18	Their roots are torn from the floor by the trees (1). Present passive (1). Meaning retained (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Rich symbolism (1). Accessible images (1). Universal theme (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Theme (1). Imagery (1). Symbolism (1). Form (1). Evaluation (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Intro (1). Idea (1). Reasons (1). Challenges (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1
20	Intro (1). Definition (1). Examples (1). Activity (1). Summary (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Format (1). Critic A (1). Critic B (1). Evidence (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1

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